

FREDERICO S. FINAN

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2018 - Professor, Department of Economics, UC-Berkeley
2018- Professor, Haas School of Business, UC-Berkeley

AFFILIATIONS

Co-Chair, Governance Initiative at Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (JPAL)
Co-Director, Berkeley's Center for Economics and Politics (BCEP)
Research Associate, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER)
Board Member and Fellow, Bureau for Research and Economic Analysis of Development (BREAD)
Board Member and Fellow, Center of Evaluation for Global Action (CEGA)
Faculty Affiliate, Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP)
Research Fellow, Institute for the Study of Labor (IZA)
Research Affiliate, International Growth Centre
Faculty Affiliate, Global Metropolitan Studies Program

EDUCATION

2006 Ph.D., University of California, Berkeley, Agricultural and Resource Economics

PUBLICATIONS IN PEER-REVIEWED JOURNALS

- “Brokering Votes with Information Spread Via Social Networks”, with Raul Duarte, Horacio Larreguy, Laura Schechter, 2025. Forthcoming at *Review of Economic Studies*.
- “Combating Political Corruption with Policy Bundles”, with Maurizio Mazzocco, 2024, Forthcoming at *Journal of Political Economy*.
- “Political Power, Elite Control, and Long-Run Development: Evidence from Brazil”, with Claudio Ferraz and Monica Martinez-Bravo, 2024, *Journal of European Economic Association*. 22(6), 2870 - 2908.
- “Economic and Social Outsiders but Political Insiders: Sweden's Populist Radical Right”, with Ernesto Dal Bó, Frederico Finan, Olle Folke, Torsten Persson, and Johanna Rickne, *Review of Economic Studies*. March 2023, 90(2), 675–706.
- “Money and Politics: The Effects of Campaign Spending Limits on Political Competition and Incumbency Advantage,” with Eric Avis, Claudio Ferraz, and Carlos Varjão, 2022. *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics* 14 (4): 167–99.
- “Voting with One’s Neighbors: Evidence from Migration within Mexico”, with Enrique Seira and Alberto Simpser, *Journal of Public Economics*, 2021, 202, 104495.

- “Electoral Incentives and the Allocation of Public Funds”, with Maurizio Mazzocco, *Journal of European Economic Association*, 2021, 19:5, 2467–2512.
- “Information Technology and Government Decentralization: Experimental Evidence from Paraguay”, with Ernesto Dal Bo, Nicholas Li, and Laura Schechter, *Econometrica*. 2021, 89: 677–701.
- “Do Government Audits Reduce Corruption? Estimating the Impacts of Exposing Corrupt Politicians”, with Eric Avis and Claudio Ferraz, *Journal of Political Economy*, 2018 126:5, 1912–1964.
- “Who Becomes a Politician”, with Ernesto Dal Bó, Olle Folke, Torsten Persson, and Johanna Rickne, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, Volume 132, Issue 4, November 2017, Pages 1877–1914.
- “Strengthening State Capabilities: The Role of Financial Incentives in the Call to Public Service”, with Ernesto Dal Bó and Martín A. Rossi, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 2013. 128 (3): 1169–1218.
- “Corrupting Learning: Evidence from Missing Federal Education Funds in Brazil”, with Claudio Ferraz and Diana B. Moreira, *Journal of Public Economics*. 2012. 96(9-10): 712–726.
- “Vote-buying and Reciprocity”, with Laura Schechter, 2012. *Econometrica*. 80(2): 863–882.
- “Local Electoral Accountability and Decentralized Program Performance”, with Alain de Janvry and Elisabeth Sadoulet, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 2012; 94(3).
- “Electoral Accountability and Corruption in Local Governments: Evidence from Audit Reports”, with Claudio Ferraz, *American Economic Review*, 2011; 101, 1274–1311.
 ➤ Awarded the 2005 Birmingham Prize and 2013 Haralambos Prize
- “Neighborhood Peer Effects in Secondary School Enrollment Decisions”, with Gustavo Bobonis, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, 2009; 91(4): 695–716.
- “Exposing Corrupt Politicians: The Effect of Brazil’s Publicly Released Audits on Electoral Outcomes”, with Claudio Ferraz, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, 2008; 123(2): 703–745.
- “Can Conditional Cash Transfers Serve as Safety Nets to Keep Children at School and Out of the Labor Market?”, with Alain de Janvry, Elisabeth Sadoulet, and Renos Vakis, *Journal of Development Economics*, 2005; 79(2): 349–373.
- “Measuring the Income Generating Potential of Land in Rural Mexico”, with Alain de Janvry and Elisabeth Sadoulet, *Journal of Development Economics* 2005; 77:27–51.
- “Errors in the Measurement of the Output Gap and the Design of Monetary Policy”, with Athanasios Orphanides, Richard Porter, Dave Reifschneider, and Robert Tetlow, *Journal of Economics and Business* 2000; 52:117–141.

COMPLETED WORKING PAPERS

- “Climate Politics in the United States”, with Matilde Bombardini, Nicolas Longuet-Marx, Suresh Naidu, Francesco Trebbi, 2025.
- “Decoupling Taste-Based versus Statistical Discrimination in Elections”, with Amanda de Albuquerque, Anubhav Jha, Laura Karpuska, Francesco Trebbi, 2025.

- “When Democracy Refuses to Die: Evaluating a Training Program for New Politicians”, with Ernesto Dal Bo, Claudio Ferraz, Pedro Pessoa, 2025. (R&R at *American Economic Review*)
- “Reinforcing RCTs with Multiple Priors while Learning about External Validity”, with Demian Pouzo, 2021, 2112.09170, arXiv.
- “Procuring Firm Growth: The Effects of Government Purchases on Firm Dynamics”, with Claudio Ferraz and Dimitri Szerman, May 2015, NBER Working Paper No. 21219.
- “Motivating Politicians: The Impacts of Monetary Incentives on Quality and Performance”, with Claudio Ferraz, January 2014.
- “A Tool for Optimal Control of Large, Forward-Looking Models”, with Robert Tetlow, Finance and Economics Discussions Working Paper, 2001.

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

- “Malfunctioning Democracies: Understanding Accountability Failures in Developing Countries”, with Claudio Ferraz, 2025. (forthcoming in North Holland’s *Handbook of Political Economy*, edited by Daron Acemoglu and James Robinson)
- “At the Intersection: A Review of Institutions in Economic Development”, with Ernesto Dal Bó, Eds. Baland, J., Bourguignon, F., Platteau, J., & Verdier, T. (2020). *The Handbook of Economic Development and Institutions*. Princeton: Princeton University Press.
- “Progress and Perspectives in the Study of Political Selection”, with Ernesto Dal Bó, *Annual Review of Economics* 2018; 10:1, 541-575
- Making Politics Work for Development: Harnessing Transparency and Citizen Engagement, with Khemani, Stuti; Dal Bó, Ernesto; Finan, Frederico S.; Stephenson Johnson, Corinne Louise; Odugbemi, Adesinaola Michael; Thapa, Dikshya; Abrahams, Scott David. 2016 Washington, D.C. : World Bank Group.
- “Fighting Political Corruption: Evidence from Brazil”, with Claudio Ferraz. December 2016, forthcoming in Eds. K. Basu and T. Cordella "*Institutions, Governance, and the Control of Corruption*".
- “The Personnel Economics of the State”, with Benjamin Olken and Rohini Pande, April 2015, Eds. Abhijit Banerjee, Esther Duflo *Handbook of Field Experiments*, North-Holland, 2 (2017) 467-514.
- “Evaluating Brazil’s Bolsa Escola Program: Governance and Decentralized Implementation”, with Alain de Janvry, Benedicte de la Briere, Peter Lanjouw, Kathy Lindert, Donald Nelson, Elisabeth Sadoulet, Social Safety Nets Primer Series, World Bank, November 2005.
- "Learning and the Complexity of Monetary Policy Rules", with Robert J. Tetlow and Peter von zur Muehlen, Benjamin Hunt and Adrian Orr (eds.) *Monetary Policy Under Uncertainty*, Wellington, New Zealand: Reserve Bank of New Zealand, 1999.

GRANTS

- 2025 “Strategic Framings for Climate Change Adaptation Legislation in Brazil”, JPAL, \$37,000.

2024	“Countering customs fraud and corruption with machine learning”, International Growth Centre, \$77,000.
2019	“Teacher Rotation and Student Outcomes: Experimental Evidence from Uganda” (Funders: USAID, JPAL, EDI. Total funding: \$1.5 million
2014	“Monitoring Public Employees in Paraguay: Can Technology Adoption by the Government Improve Agricultural Extension Services for Poor Farmers?” International Growth Centre (IGC), \$252,249
2014	Governance Initiative Grant, JPAL, \$47,776
2011	Governance Initiative Grant, JPAL, \$35,000
2009	National Science Foundation: Research Grant (PI), \$250,000
2007	Senate Grant, \$10,000
2007	NICHD Pilot Grant, Population Research Center, \$10,000
2007	Latin American Studies Grant, \$15,000
2006	NICHD Pilot Grant, California Center for Population Research, \$20,000